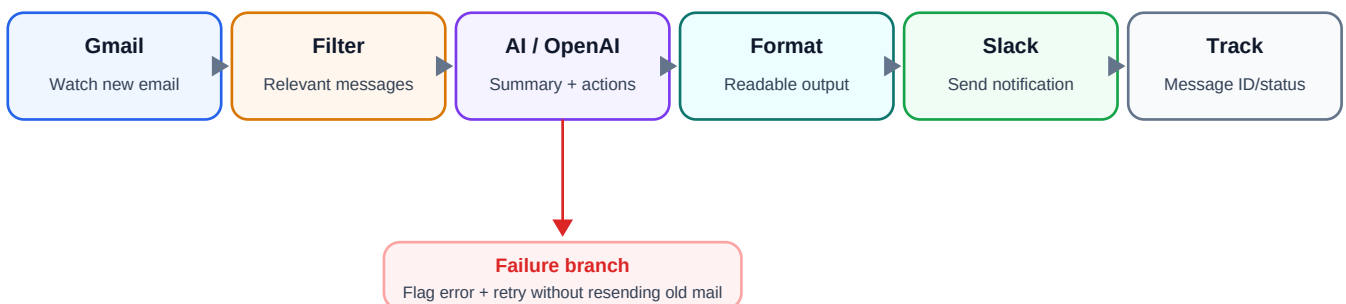


AI Email Summarization & Slack Automation

A practical workflow for filtering Gmail messages, generating structured AI summaries and action items, and delivering concise notifications to Slack without duplicate processing.

Goal Reduce repetitive inbox review while keeping important emails easy to scan and act on.	Core stack Gmail - n8n / Make - OpenAI API - Slack	Reliability focus Filtering, message-ID tracking, structured output, retries and visible errors.
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Workflow architecture



How I would structure the build

1. Email gate	Watch incoming Gmail and apply sender, label, category, or keyword rules before any AI call so newsletters, receipts, or automated messages can be excluded.
2. Message extraction	Pass only the sender, subject, clean body text, thread link, and message ID needed by the workflow.
3. Structured AI output	Prompt the model to return separate fields such as summary, action items, and optional priority/category instead of one unstructured paragraph.
4. Slack delivery	Format the result into a readable Slack message with sender, subject, concise summary, action items, and a link back to the Gmail thread.
5. Duplicate / error control	Record the message ID and processing status. Temporary AI/API failures route to an error path so they can be retried without intentionally resending already-processed messages.

Output, controls and test plan

The useful part of this automation is not just the summary. It is the combination of filtering, readable structure, traceability and safe retries.

Example Slack message

From: John Smith
Subject: Website launch approval

Summary:
The client approved the final website version and requested launch on Friday.

Action Items:

- Confirm Friday launch time
- Send final access details
- Prepare post-launch checklist

Demonstration data only.

Filtering and reliability controls

Noise filtering	Exclude newsletters, receipts, automated notifications, or other unwanted categories before sending content to the AI model.
Thread / message identity	Use Gmail message IDs (and, when useful, thread IDs) to identify what has already been processed.
Structured response validation	Check required fields such as summary and action items before sending a Slack message.
Visible failures	Write or route errors to a dedicated branch instead of silently ending the workflow.
Retry behavior	Retry transient API failures while preserving the processed-state logic so previous messages are not intentionally duplicated.

End-to-end test plan

Test	What I verify
Normal business email	Filtered in, summarized correctly, action items separated, Slack message delivered once.
Excluded email	Newsletter/receipt-type message is filtered out before AI processing.
Same thread / repeat event	Old content is not intentionally resent because message identity is tracked.
Controlled API failure	Error is visible and a retry can occur without losing context or duplicating completed work.

Scope note: This document is an independent workflow sample prepared to demonstrate the proposed implementation approach. It is not presented as a completed client deployment or as evidence of client results.